

‘Refute and be refuted’



Much like Socrates, philosophy professor Agnes Callard believes in the power of a full-blown argument.



E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Telling their own story

A bus tour of the South Side delves into Chicago’s key role in America’s Black Muslim history.

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Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM



‘SMARTEST FOOTBALL MIND IN THE ROOM’

How Ben Johnson’s background shaped the new Bears coach’s rise



Above: Ben Johnson’s parents keep pictures and memorabilia from his football career at their home outside Asheville, North Carolina. Top: The sun sets through the trees on the football field at A.C. Reynolds High School on Feb. 3 in Asheville, where Johnson played quarterback. BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS

By Brad Biggs
Chicago Tribune

ASHEVILLE, N.C. — Displayed in a wicker chair on the front porch of Ben Johnson’s boyhood home, atop a hill 15 minutes southeast of downtown, is a framed sign with North Carolina Tar Heels logos that reads, “Whatever It Takes.”

It represents what the region the new Chicago Bears coach hails from is going through: cleanup and rebuilding from the devastating aftermath of Hurricane Helene as residents work to put lives and businesses back together. The Asheville airport recorded 13.98 inches of rain from Sept. 25-27, with some areas in the Blue Ridge Mountains getting more than 2 feet and Busick, an hour away, measuring nearly 31 inches.

Johnson’s parents, Don and Gail, moved back into the home Jan. 15 after being displaced for 111 days. Three trees fell on the house, creating a hole large enough to drive a truck through. Unfinished work remains for contractors. Drinking water wasn’t restored until last month at nearby A.C. Reynolds High School, where Johnson graduated and quarterbacked the Rockets to a state championship in 2002.

Turn to Coach, Page 8

Conflict persists between leaders

Behind-the-scenes staff acrimony mirrors public tension between Johnson and Pritzker

By A.D. Quig and Alice Yin
Chicago Tribune

Hours before Gov. JB Pritzker suffered a rare defeat in Springfield over a hemp bill opposed by Mayor Brandon Johnson, the governor’s chief of staff withdrew from a short-lived effort to convene with Chicago and Cook County counterparts to plan for President Donald Trump’s second term.

On Jan. 6, Anne Caprara sent a curt email informing the chiefs of staff to the mayor and Cook County Board president that she was opting out of their “scenario planning” meetings organized shortly after Trump’s November win.

“I won’t be participating in these meetings going forward,” Caprara wrote in the exchange obtained by the Tribune via an open records request, adding that she intended to later “catch up separately” with County Board President Toni Preckwinkle’s chief of staff.

The three chiefs of staff had met twice in December, the emails indicate, and were planning their next session for mid-January until Caprara’s email appeared to cut out Johnson’s chief of staff, former state Sen. Cristina Pacione-Zayas.

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INSIDE

‘He didn’t get enough credit for what he did’

Dick Jauron, who led the Bears to a 13-win season in 2001, died Saturday at 74. The Peoria native was recently diagnosed with cancer.



No verdict; jury gets deep in legal weeds

Deliberations in the Michael Madigan trial have gone on for about 50 hours over eight days since Jan. 29. Chicagoland, Page 3

SUPER BOWL LIX 5:30 P.M. SUNDAY, FOX

CHIEFS CHASE THREE-PEAT



Kansas City’s quest to win its third Super Bowl in a row faces its ultimate challenge: the Eagles. If the Chiefs win, it will be NFL history. If it’s Philly, it will be special. Chicago Sports

O’Hare is Chicago’s biggest CO2 emitter; Indiana factories are region’s top polluters

By John Lippert
Chicago Tribune

In 2023, O’Hare International Airport and its screaming jet engines were Chicago’s biggest single source of carbon dioxide, accounting for one-tenth of the city’s total.

Half of Chicago’s CO2 came from a transportation system choked with cross-country freight and the worst traffic congestion in the United States.

Only an eighth of the city’s CO2

came from industry, and almost none from generating electricity.

These are highlights from a first-of-its-kind computer model from Crosswalk Labs. The Washington, D.C., firm tracks and visualizes emissions data from every sector of the economy in neighborhoods across the United States.

According to Crosswalk Labs, Chicago’s transportation emissions have been rising since the COVID-19 pandemic, contributing to the city’s total emissions remaining flat despite a promise of steep

cuts from a parade of corporate and government leaders.

Americans love to move around. That’s a big reason they’re sticking with carbon-saturated lifestyles despite record heat and raging wildfires worldwide, said Zac Adelman, executive director of the Lake Michigan Air Directors Consortium, or LADCO.

Last month, the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration declared 2024 the hottest

Turn to Emissions, Page 4



An American Airlines jet taxis on the runway after landing at O’Hare International Airport on Jan. 29. E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

